

**25/02/2025**

**Problem Set 2**

Part (1) (10 points)

At MT1 the underlined problems must be done and turned in for grading. The others are some suggested choices for more practice.

A listing like §1B: 2, 5b, 10" do the indicated problems from supplementary problems section B.

**1) Matrices and inverse matrices**

- §1F: 5b, 8a; others: 5a, 9
- §1G: 3, 4, 5j

**2) Theorems about square system: Equation of Planes**

- §1H: 3a, 6c; others: 7
- §1E: 1c, d, 2, b; other 1a, b, e, 3, 5

**Part II (17 points)**

**Problem I (6.1, 2 (2))**

Suppose we know that when the three planes  $P_1$ ,  $P_2$ , and  $P_3$  intersect in pairs, we get three lines  $L_1$ ,  $L_2$ , and  $L_3$  which are distinct and parallel.

- Sketch a picture of the situation.
- Show that the three normals to  $P_1$ ,  $P_2$ , and  $P_3$  all lie in one plane using a geometric argument.
- Show that the three normals to  $P_1$ ,  $P_2$ , and  $P_3$  all lie in one plane using an algebraic argument.  
(Why 3 planes do not intersect.)

**Problem II (6.3: 1, 2)**

A manufacturing process mixes three raw materials  $M_1$ ,  $M_2$ ,  $M_3$  to produce three products  $P_1$ ,  $P_2$ , and  $P_3$ . The ratios of the amounts of the raw materials (in the order  $M_1$ ,  $M_2$ ,  $M_3$ ) which are used to make up each of the three products are as follows:

For  $P_1$  the ratio is 1 : 2 : 3.

For  $P_2$  the ratio is 1 : 3 : 5, and for  $P_3$  the ratio is 3 : 5 : 8.

In a certain production run, 137 units of  $M_1$  and 279 units of each of the products  $P_1$ ,  $P_2$ ,  $P_3$  were produced in that run.

- (a) Set this problem up in matrix form. Use the letter  $A$  for the matrix and write down the (one-line) formula for the solution in matrix form.
- (b) Compute the inverse of  $A$  and use it to solve for the production vector  $\mathbf{P}$ .
- (c) Find a choice for the ratios for the third product (in lowest form), different from the other two ratios, for which the resulting system has non-unique solutions.

**Problem 3 (6.4, 2)**

For any plane  $P$  which is not parallel to the  $xy$ -plane, define the steepest direction on  $P$  to be the direction of any vector on  $P$  which makes the largest (acute) angle with the  $xy$ -plane.

**Problem Set 2, Part II**

1. (a) Let  $P$  be the plane through the origin with normal vector  $\mathbf{n}$ . Derive a formula, in terms of  $\mathbf{n}$ , for a vector  $\mathbf{w}$  which points in the steepest direction on  $P$ .
- (b) Now let  $P$  be the plane through the origin which contains two non-parallel vectors  $\mathbf{u}$  and  $\mathbf{v}$ , where  $\mathbf{u}$  and  $\mathbf{v}$  do not both lie in the  $xy$ -plane. Derive a formula, in terms of  $\mathbf{u}$  and  $\mathbf{v}$ , for a vector  $\mathbf{w}$  which points in the steepest direction on  $P$ .

Since  $\mathbf{n}_1 \times \mathbf{n}_2$  is parallel to  $\mathbf{n}_2 \times \mathbf{n}_3$ , we can write one as a scalar multiple of the other.

$$\mathbf{x} \cdot \mathbf{n}_i = a_i$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{n}_1 \\ \mathbf{n}_2 \\ \mathbf{n}_3 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{v} = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ a_2 \\ a_3 \end{pmatrix}$$

So the determinant of the matrix on the left must be zero, hence

$$0 = \det \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{n}_1 \\ \mathbf{n}_2 \\ \mathbf{n}_3 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{n}_1 \cdot (\mathbf{n}_2 \times \mathbf{n}_3)$$

Therefore, the three normals are coplanar.

**Q2(a)**

In one unit of  $P_1$ , there are  $\frac{1}{6}$  of a unit of  $M_1$ ,  $\frac{2}{6}$  of a unit of  $M_2$ , and  $\frac{3}{6}$  of a unit of  $M_3$ .

So, to produce  $P_1$ , we need

$$\frac{1}{6}P_1 \text{ units of } M_1, \quad \frac{2}{6}P_1 \text{ units of } M_2, \quad \frac{3}{6}P_1 \text{ units of } M_3.$$

Using similar reasoning for  $P_2$  and  $P_3$ , the linear system is

$$A\mathbf{p} = \mathbf{m}.$$

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{6} & \frac{1}{9} & \frac{3}{16} \\ \frac{1}{3} & \frac{1}{9} & \frac{1}{16} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{9} & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

(b)

$$|A| = \frac{1}{864} \neq 0 \quad \text{and hence } A^{-1} \text{ exists.}$$

$$\mathbf{p} = A^{-1}\mathbf{m}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} -6 & 42 & -24 \\ -9 & -9 & 9 \\ 16 & -32 & 16 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} m_1 \\ m_2 \\ m_3 \end{pmatrix}$$

If

$$\mathbf{m} = \langle 137, 279, 448 \rangle^T,$$

then

$$\mathbf{p} = A^{-1}\mathbf{m} = \langle 144, 288, 432 \rangle^T.$$

So, 144 units of  $P_1$ , 288 units of  $P_2$ , and 432 units of  $P_3$  are produced.

(c)

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{6} & \frac{1}{9} & \frac{1}{2} \left( \frac{1}{6} + \frac{1}{9} \right) \\ \frac{1}{3} & \frac{1}{3} & \frac{1}{3} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{5}{9} & \frac{1}{2} \left( \frac{1}{2} + \frac{5}{9} \right) \end{pmatrix}$$